





IN THE SPIRIT OF SERVICE
(Clockwise from top left) Sri Sathya Sai University for Human Excellence, Kalaburagi; Sri Sathya Sai Mother and Child Hospital, Yavatmal, Maharashtra; Sri Sathya Sai Prasanthi Niketan for Girls, Siddipet, Telangana

CHILD HOSPITALS
In Nava Raipur (Chhattisgarh),Yavatmal (Maharashtra), Palwal (Haryana) and Raiwala (Uttarakhand)

↘ DIVINE MOTHER AND CHILD HEALTH PROGRAMME
A comprehensive early detection and systemic health screening programme for rural school-going children and expecting or lactating mothers. Also provides multi-nutrient supplements to address their specific nutritional needs

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI SARLA MEMORIAL HOSPITAL
A 300-bed multi-speciality high dependency in-patient facility at Sathya Sai Grama, Muddenahalli

↘ AAROGYA VAHINI TRUST
Provides free-of-cost healthcare services to vulnerable communities in rural West Bengal, Jharkhand, Bihar and Assam

↘ PRASHANTI BALAMANDIRA TRUST
It provides free healthcare and plans to establish a medical college by 2023 to offer medical education completely free of cost to the rural poor with an investment of Rs 300 crore and including a 400-bed hospital at Sathya Sai Grama, Muddenahalli

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI ARADHANA TRUST
Organises yajnas and pujas, besides religious and spiritual talks

THE SATHYA SAI NETWORK

Institutions run by the Puttaparthi establishment

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI CENTRAL TRUST
Apex panel set up by Sri Sathya Sai Baba to oversee all activities initiated by him

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI INSTITUTE OF HIGHER LEARNING
Runs free undergraduate and post-graduate programmes

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI VIDYA VAHINI
An edtech platform

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI CENTRE FOR HUMAN VALUES
Develops content for publications and training programmes to enhance the understanding and practice of Sathya Sai's teachings

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI SADHANA TRUST
Rolls out educational material about Sathya Sai and his teachings in digital formats

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI INSTITUTE OF HIGHER MEDICAL SCIENCES, PRASANTIGRAM
A 300-bed super-speciality hospital in Puttaparthi

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI INSTITUTE OF HIGHER MEDICAL SCIENCES, BENGALURU
A 333-bed super speciality hospital

↘ SRI SATHYA SAI MOBILE HOSPITAL PROGRAMME
A rural outreach health service from the first to the 12th day of every month serves 63 villages near Puttaparthi

Kulwant Hall, devotees recently pledged to take up Narayana Seva—feeding the poor—in the run-up to the centenary celebrations of 'Bhagwan's Divine Advent' in November 2025. On November 20, during the 97th birthday celebrations, Nimish Pandya, all-India president of the Sri Sathya Sai Seva Organisations (SSSSO), announced a target of feeding one million people by 2025.

In 2020, Rathnakar lobbied with the United Nations Economic and Social Council and managed to secure global recognition for the SSSCT's humanitarian work in 2020. A year later, he set up the Sri Sathya Sai Global Council (SSSGC) to guide the activities of the SSSSOs in India and other countries. All the rituals and social outreach through education and health services initiated in the guru's lifetime continue under Rathnakar's leadership, with a few additions such as a convention centre and the Sri Sathya Sai Media Centre in Prasanthi Nilayam and a multimedia museum at Brindavan, Whitefield, in Bengaluru. Puttaparthi is now also the headquarters of a district named after Sathya Sai, thanks to Rathnakar's lobbying with Andhra Pradesh chief minister Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy.

On May 8 this year, SSSGC cautioned devotees that it has nothing to do with the California-headquartered SSSIO or any of its constituents that back Madhusudan. It stated that it has no affiliation to or recognition from the SSSCT in Prasanthi Nilayam or from Sri Sathya Sai organisations in the US and other parts of the world affiliated to the Global Council. SSSGC has also rejected Madhusudan's claim that he channels the spirit of the late Sathya Sai, though mere rejection of the claim may not be sufficient to rein in the breakaway group. Rathnakar refused to speak despite several attempts by INDIA TODAY to contact him.

However, despite Rathnakar's various initiatives, Prasanthi Nilayam has not been able to increase the flow of devotees or expand its social outreach. As of now, Sathya Sai's legacy seems to be doing far better under Madhusudhan's leadership, aided by the massive expansion he has engineered. Rathnakar may find himself confined to Puttaparthi and its environs. ■

with Ajay Sukumaran